

HOW TO USE THIS BINDER

Welcome to your Owner-Builder Job Site Binder! This comprehensive system will help you stay organized, track progress, maintain legal compliance, and manage every aspect of your construction project from start to finish.

Introduction to the Binder System

This binder is designed as your central command center for managing your owner-builder construction project. It contains all the forms, checklists, and documentation templates you need to maintain professional records throughout your build. Keep this binder on-site and accessible at all times for maximum effectiveness.

Organizing the 8 Sections

The binder is divided into eight color-coded sections for easy navigation:

- **Section 1: Project Planning & Foundation** - Use this during pre-construction and foundation phases. Start here with your master timeline and budget.
- **Section 2: Contracts & Legal Documents** - Store all subcontractor agreements, change orders, lien waivers, and payment records here. Update after every transaction.
- **Section 3: Rough-In Phase** - Reference these forms during framing and rough-in inspections for electrical, plumbing, and HVAC systems.
- **Section 4: Systems Installation** - Track final installation of all mechanical, electrical, and plumbing systems before closing walls.

- **Section 5: Finish Work** - Use during interior finishing phases including drywall, trim, flooring, cabinets, and painting.
- **Section 6: Daily Operations** - Complete daily logs, track material deliveries, weather delays, and safety incidents throughout the project.
- **Section 7: Budget & Expenses** - Maintain all financial records, receipts, expense tracking, and budget reconciliation documents.
- **Section 8: Quick Reference Guides** - Access code requirements, span tables, calculators, and emergency contacts quickly.

When to Use Each Form

Daily: Complete the Daily Job Site Log (6.1) and Material Delivery Log (6.3) every day work occurs on site.

Before Starting Each Phase: Review the relevant section's checklists and forms to ensure you're prepared.

Before Inspections: Complete the appropriate inspection checklist to verify all requirements are met.

When Hiring Subcontractors: Use the Subcontractor Agreement Template (2.1) and track payments with the Payment Draw Schedule (2.4).

For Every Expense: Log in Expense Tracking Sheets (7.1) and file receipts in the Receipt Organization System (7.2).

When Changes Occur: Document all changes with Change Order Forms (2.2) immediately.

Tips for Staying Organized During Construction

- **Make it a habit:** Set aside 15 minutes at the end of each day to update your logs and file receipts.
- **Use sheet protectors:** Place frequently-referenced documents and blank forms in clear sheet protectors to prevent wear and tear.
- **Take photos:** Supplement your written logs with photos stored digitally, referenced by date in your daily logs.

- **Update your timeline weekly:** Review Section 1's Master Project Timeline every Sunday to adjust for actual progress.

Recommended Supplies

- **3-ring binder:** Heavy-duty 2.5" or 3" binder with D-rings for durability
- **8 divider tabs:** Labeled for each section (consider color-coded tabs)
- **Clear sheet protectors:** At least 50 for protecting documents
- **Three-hole punch:** For adding new documents to the binder
- **Sticky notes and flags:** For marking important pages